

IN PROFILE

Nadia Boulanger

A towering figure in Lili's life, Nadia Boulanger (1887–1979) was a highly distinguished conductor and organist and one of the 20th century's most influential teachers of composition. Like Lili, Nadia was tutored by Gabriel Fauré at the Conservatoire de Paris. She came second in the 1908 Prix de Rome with her cantata *La Sirène*. When her father died in 1903, Nadia's teaching became a vital source of financial support for the family. She went on to instruct numerous eminent composers, many from the US, including Aaron Copland and Philip Glass. After Lili's death, Nadia was tireless in her promotion of her sister's work.



NADIA BOULANGER CONDUCTING AN ORCHESTRA IN MANCHESTER,
AGED 76

Marie Juliette Olga Boulanger, known as Lili, was born in Paris in 1893 to a musical family: her parents were notable musicians and her sister, Nadia, went on to become a famous conductor and tutor (see [box](#)). Lili grew up around leading musicians and intellectuals of the age, including the composer and close family friend, [Gabriel Fauré](#), who became her piano tutor and had a